CAREER

Data Career Playbook

Indicative salary bands, the 90-day switch plan, resume fixes and AI prompts that save hours.

Indicative salary bands in India (2026)

Experience	Data Analyst	Data Scientist
0-2 years	₹4-8 LPA	₹6-12 LPA
2-5 years	₹8-15 LPA	₹12-25 LPA
5-8 years	₹15-25 LPA	₹25-40 LPA

Ranges vary a lot by city, company type and domain. Use them as a direction, not a promise.

What moves you from ₹4 to ₹15 LPA

1. SQL at window-function level, not just SELECT and JOIN.
2. One BI tool done properly (Power BI or Tableau).
3. Talking in business impact: "cut report time from 6 hours to 20 minutes".
4. Domain depth (BFSI, e-commerce, supply chain).
5. Switching companies with 2-3 strong projects to show.

90-day plan for non-tech to data analyst

Weeks	Focus	Output
1-3	Excel	One dashboard
4-7	SQL	50 solved questions
8-10	Power BI	One end-to-end report
11-12	Python basics + statistics	One EDA notebook
13	Resume, LinkedIn, applications	20 targeted applications

5 resume mistakes I see every week

1. Listing tools without saying what you did with them.
2. No numbers. Add time saved, revenue, rows, accuracy.
3. Course certificates at the top, projects at the bottom.
4. Two pages for under 3 years of experience.
5. Projects copied from the same YouTube tutorial everyone uses.

What I check when I take an interview

- Can you explain your own project without reading?
- Do you ask about the business question before writing SQL?
- Can you spot a wrong number in your own output?

- Do you know the trade-off of what you chose?

5 AI prompts that save hours

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1. "Here is my table schema: [paste]. Write a SQL query to [goal]. Explain each step."
2. "This Excel formula returns #N/A: [paste]. List the likely causes in order."
3. "Summarise this pivot output into 5 bullet insights for a sales head: [paste]."
4. "Write DAX for year-on-year growth with a Date table called 'Date'."
5. "Review this Pandas code for bugs and performance: [paste]."
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Will AI replace analysts? It replaces the typing, not the judgement. Knowing which question to ask and whether the answer is wrong is the job. Use AI to go faster and say so in interviews.

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